FORWARD SUPPORT

PLACEMENT INFORMATION PACK

A home built around the people who live here.

A five-bed CQC registered residential home in Taunton, specialising in long-term care for adults with learning disabilities. For commissioners, social workers, and professionals considering a placement.

"Care and support you can believe in."

Version 2.0 · April 2026

Forward Support Care Ltd
Catherine House, Taunton
01823 630750

INTRODUCTION

Welcome to Catherine House

This pack gives you the full picture of what we do, who we support, and how a placement with us works. If anything is missing or you would like to discuss a specific individual, please contact us directly.

Catherine House is a five-bed residential care home on Hamilton Road in the centre of Taunton. We specialise in long-term residential care for adults with learning disabilities, and have operated continuously at this location for over a decade.

The home is operated by Forward Support Care Ltd, with **Laura Luxon** as our Registered Manager. Laura is in the home every day and knows every person who lives here. She is your primary point of contact for any enquiry, assessment, or ongoing placement matter.

We are a small, owner-led provider by design. We do not operate a chain, we do not plan to grow beyond what we can personally oversee, and we believe that is what makes the home work for the people who live here.

Key Service Facts

SERVICE NAME	Catherine House
PROVIDER	Forward Support Care Ltd (Company No. 12330119)
CQC PROVIDER ID	1-8336100647
CQC LOCATION ID	1-18578774379
SERVICE TYPE	Residential Care (CQC regulated activity: Accommodation for persons who require personal care)
REGISTERED SPECIALISMS	Learning Disabilities · Sensory Impairments · Younger Adults (under 65)
REGISTERED CAPACITY	5 adults
SERVICE HOURS	24 hours a day, 7 days a week

REGISTERED MANAGER	Ms Laura Ami Luxon
ADDRESS	131 Hamilton Road, Taunton, Somerset, TA1 2EP
TELEPHONE	01823 630750
EMAIL	info@forwardsupport.co.uk
WEBSITE	forwardsupport.co.uk

About our CQC rating

Catherine House was rated **Good** at its last full CQC inspection. In June 2024, the provider registration moved from a sole trader to Forward Support Care Ltd as a limited company. CQC treats a change of provider as a new registration, so our first inspection under the new registration is pending. The team, the home, and the standards are the same.

WHO WE SUPPORT

Designed around stability and individuality.

We specialise in long-term placements for adults with learning disabilities. Stability matters enormously in this population, and everything we do is designed to support long, settled lives here.

Primary Client Group

- Adults aged 18 to 65 with a diagnosed learning disability
- Adults with co-occurring sensory impairments, autism, or complex communication needs
- Adults for whom residential care is the agreed care setting, whether funded by their local authority, NHS continuing healthcare, a mix, or privately

What we do provide

- 24 hour personal care and support
- Person-centred care and support planning
- Mental Capacity Act 2005 compliant decision-making
- Positive behaviour support for challenging behaviour
- Medication management (QCS compliant)
- Support with daily living skills
- Community access and activities
- Family and advocate engagement
- Health appointment attendance and liaison
- Safeguarding in line with Somerset SAB procedures

What we do not provide

- Nursing care (we are not registered for this)
- Respite care (at present, no vacancies)
- Short-term emergency placements under 3 months
- Placements for individuals under 18
- Placements where the primary need is substance misuse or acute mental health
- Placements for individuals requiring one-to-one where this cannot be funded

Admission Criteria

We assess every referral individually. The fundamental questions we consider are:

- Will the person be well matched with the existing group at Catherine House
- Can we meet their needs with the staffing and skills we have or can recruit
- Is a long-term residential placement the right setting for this person
- Is the funding or commissioning position clear and sustainable

Matching is the most important of these. A five-bed home depends on compatibility, and we will decline a placement if we do not believe the person will thrive here. This protects everyone, including the individual being referred.

THE PROCESS

A clear process from first referral to move-in.

Our placement process is designed to be thorough, transparent, and respectful of everyone's time. Typical timescale from initial referral to move-in is 4 to 8 weeks, depending on assessment and funding panels.

1

Initial referral and conversation

You contact Laura directly by phone or email with basic information about the individual and their needs. We will typically have an initial 20 to 30 minute conversation within one working day to establish whether we could be a match.

2

Information sharing

If the initial conversation is positive, we ask for supporting documentation including recent needs assessment, positive behaviour support plan if relevant, medication profile, and any risk assessments. This allows us to make an informed response.

3

Pre-assessment meeting

Laura visits the individual in their current setting where possible, or meets with their circle of support. This is a conversation, not a formal assessment. We are establishing whether we are the right home, and you are establishing whether we can meet the need.

4

Introduction to Catherine House

Where appropriate, we invite the individual and their family or representatives to visit the home. This can be as many visits as needed. We believe a person moving in should have chosen to come, not merely consented.

5

Written assessment and proposal

We provide a written assessment response setting out whether we can meet need, the proposed staffing model, and the proposed fee. This goes to you and the individual's representatives for consideration.

6

Funding agreement

We work with your funding panel, contracts team, or broker as applicable to finalise the placement agreement. We accept all mainstream funding routes including local authority funding, NHS CHC, joint-funded packages, and private.

7

Transition planning and move-in

Once the placement is agreed, we plan a transition at the right pace for the individual. This might be a single move-in day or a phased introduction over several weeks. Laura leads this personally.

FEES AND FUNDING

Fair, transparent, and individually assessed.

We do not publish standard fees. Each fee is set following full assessment and reflects the actual cost of meeting that individual's needs well. This is the most honest way to price care.

How our fees are structured

Our weekly fee covers accommodation, meals, personal care, 24 hour specialist support staffing, activity coordination, medication management, and all everyday costs of living in the home. It does not include items that vary individually such as personal spending money, clothing, hairdressing, or holiday costs. These are handled separately through the individual's personal allowance and family support.

How we arrive at a fee

- We review the needs assessment and positive behaviour support plan
- We determine the staffing model required (including whether one-to-one support is needed at any time of day)
- We calculate the cost of delivering that model sustainably
- We propose a fee that reflects that cost honestly, with no hidden uplifts

> **Please contact us to discuss**
>
> Every placement is different. Rather than publish a range that may mislead, we ask commissioners and brokers to contact us with the details of the individual, and we will provide a clear written fee proposal as part of our assessment response. Call Laura on 01823 630750 or email info@forwardsupport.co.uk.

Funding routes we accept

- Local authority funded placements (Somerset, Devon, and other authorities)
- NHS Continuing Healthcare
- Joint funded placements (LA and NHS)
- Personal budgets and direct payments
- Private self-funders
- Section 117 aftercare where applicable

Payment terms

Invoices are issued monthly in advance. Payment terms are 30 days net for commissioning authorities. For private payers, terms are agreed individually as part of the placement agreement.

GOVERNANCE AND QUALITY

Small home. Serious systems.

Being a small, owner-led home does not mean informal governance. We run Catherine House with the full policy framework, professional support, and accountability of a much larger organisation.

Policy and compliance framework

Our full policy suite is provided and maintained by **Quality Compliance Systems (QCS)**, covering all areas required under CQC's Key Lines of Enquiry. Policies are reviewed and updated centrally and reflect the most current regulatory guidance. Key policies available to commissioners on request include:

- Safeguarding Adults Policy and Procedure (CR74)
- Mental Capacity Act 2005 Policy and Procedure (CR88)
- Positive Behaviour Support Policy and Procedure (CC141)
- Medicines Management Policy and Procedure (CN02)
- Person Centred Care and Support Planning (CP11)
- Dignity, Respect and Choice Policy and Procedure (CR06)
- Equality and Diversity Policy and Procedure (PE03)
- Recruitment Policy and Procedure (PR26)

- Complaints, Suggestions and Compliments Policy (QQ03)
- Promotion of Recreational Activities Policy (CR16)

Professional support

HR & EMPLOYMENT LAW	**Peninsula** (partnered since 2011)
EMPLOYEE ASSISTANCE	**Health Assured** (via Peninsula)
POLICY FRAMEWORK	**Quality Compliance Systems (QCS)**
PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP	**RCPA** (Registered Care Providers Association)
WORKFORCE REGISTRATION	**Skills for Care** registered provider
DATA PROTECTION	**ICO** registered (reference ZB808447)

Safeguarding

We operate under Somerset Safeguarding Adults Board procedures. All staff complete safeguarding training at induction and annually thereafter. Laura is the designated safeguarding lead and is supported by Alison Thorne as Nominated Individual under our CQC registration. Any safeguarding concern is reported to the local authority within the expected timescale and we fully cooperate with any subsequent enquiry.

OUR TEAM

People you know, who know the people they support.

Catherine House is staffed by a small, stable team who work directly with the same individuals day after day. Low staff turnover is one of the most important quality indicators in learning disability residential care, and it is something we protect actively.

Staffing approach

- All support staff recruited through our Peninsula-supported recruitment process, including enhanced DBS checks, right to work verification, and reference checks
- Minimum Care Certificate induction within first 12 weeks
- Ongoing training via QCS training portal, including Positive Behaviour Support, Mental Capacity Act, Safeguarding, Medication, and Learning Disability specific modules
- Supervision monthly, appraisal annually
- Health Assured Employee Assistance Programme available to all staff
- Pay above the statutory minimum (from £12.50 per hour at time of writing)

Key Contacts

REGISTERED MANAGER

Laura Luxon

First point of contact for any placement enquiry, assessment, or ongoing matter.

01823 630750

info@forwardsupport.co.uk

SERVICE ADDRESS

Catherine House

Visits by appointment, weekday daytime preferred.

131 Hamilton Road

Taunton, Somerset

TA1 2EP

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Forward Support Care Ltd
Company No. 12330119

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